



HISE 312

Assignment 1

Methodology:

Critiquing and Improving an AI-Generated Lesson Plan

Group members:

R Bull 33777233

H Minty 53089235

RC Lewis 52896196

Index

Assignment content:	Page
PART A: Critique	3-4
PART B: Improved lesson plan	5-13
Source Pack	14-18
PART C: Short reflection	19
Reference list	20
Rubric	21-22

Critique of Grade 11 Lesson Plan**Introduction/Conclusion****Warm-up creates bias too quickly:**

Starting with “Who is mostly to blame for conflict in the Middle East today?” jumps straight into opinion without first setting class expectations. In a diverse class, this could immediately create tension. **Problem:** CAPS promotes multiple perspectives and respectful agreement.

Improvement: Spend 5 minutes co-creating classroom discussion rules (e.g., listen respectfully, use evidence). This makes the students feel comfortable enough to participate in the discussion without fear.

No clear historical distancing:

Allowing learners to share religious views is fine, but there’s no reminder that this is historical analysis, not personal endorsement. **Problem:** In sensitive nationalism topics, silence can be interpreted as agreement. **Improvement:** Add a short “historical lens” reminder: we are analysing the past as historians, not debating current politics or faith.

Conclusion lacks consolidation:

Simply summarising and asking “Do you understand?” doesn’t link back to key aims like cause and effect. **Problem:** Learners leave without fully consolidating Arab vs Jewish nationalism origins. **Improvement:** Do a quick pair activity: One cause of each nationalism and how they clashed.

Exit question promotes agreement, not enquiry:

“Do you agree with what we learned?” frames history as opinion. **Problem:** Undermines CAPS historical enquiry skills. **Improvement:** Ask: “What evidence challenged your thinking today?” to promote reflection.

Teaching Strategy and Approach**Over reliance on lecture (35 mins):**

Extended board notes limits enquiry and learner engagement. **Problem:** CAPS promotes source-based, enquiry learning. Grade 11s disengage easily. **Improvement:** Break into 15 minute mini-lecture and 20 minute jigsaw using sources on each nationalism.

Debate lacks structure:

A 5-minute open debate with selected speakers risks becoming unbalanced. **Problem:** sensitive topics can turn emotional and favour dominant voices. **Improvement:** randomly assign sides, give 2-minute prep with evidence, rotate speakers.

No differentiation:

All learners copy notes and read the same text. **Problem:** doesn't support slower readers or ESL learners. **Improvement:** tiered tasks such as, visual timeline option, scaffolded summary questions, extension analysis for stronger learners.

Time management unclear:

Listenphases seem rushed. **Problem:** faster pacing disadvantages weaker learners. **Improvement:** use strict timers and build in a small buffer (cut debate if needed).

Limited Viewpoints:

Although CAPS stresses multiple perspectives, activities remain twofold (Arab versus Jewish). **Problem:** over simplifies a complex issue. **Improvement:** add a third perspective (neutral historian or British mandate source) through a source--analysis station.

Assessments and Resources

No record of informal assessment:

Warm-ups and exit slips on to record it. **Problem:** no evidence for moderation or tracking caps skills. **Improvement:** use a simple checklist or Google form link to 3 key aims.

Summative quiz vague:

Multiple choice on dates or definitions may assess recall only. **Problem:** risks testing trivia instead of understanding nationalism differences. **Improvement:** include application questions (e.g., link a cause to the correct nationalism).

Homework encourages opinion without evidence:

"One page: Who is right?" with no sources reinforces bias. **Problem:** CAPS requires evidence-based arguments. **Improvement:** require 2 sources plus a short reflection, assessed with a rubric.

Incomplete resources:

YouTube clips and quiz mentioned but not attached. **Problem:** wastes prep time. **Improvement:** include hyperlinks and attach the quiz in the lesson plan.

Limited resource diversity:

Only textbook and handbook used. **Problem:** may create one sided narrative. **Improvement:** add one balanced primary source per nationalism (e.g., Arab Revolt document and Zionist Congress speech).

Completed by H. Minty 53089235

Algemene inligting/ General Information

Vak/Subject: _____History_____ Graad/Grade: _____11____ Datum/Date: 13 February 2026

Onderwerp/Topic: Nationalism in the Middle East (Term 3)

Lesonderwerp/Lesson topic: Origins of Arab nationalism and Jewish nationalism

Student/Student: _____ Studente nommer/Student number: _____

Skool/School: _____ Onderwyser/Teacher: _____

Spesifieke doelstellings van Geskiedenis is om die volgende te skep / Specific objectives of History is to create the following:

X	'n belangstelling in en genot van die studie van die verlede / <i>an interest in and enjoyment of the study of the past.</i>
	begrip en waardering van die verlede en die kragte wat dit vorm / <i>knowledge, understanding and appreciation of the past and the forces that shape it.</i>
X	die vermoë om 'n proses van historiese ondersoek te onderneem wat gebaseer is op vaardighede / <i>the ability to undertake a process of historical enquiry based on skills.</i>
X	'n begrip van historiese konsepte, met inbegrip van historiese bronne en getuienis / <i>an understanding of historical concepts, including historical sources and evidence.</i>

Vaardighede van Geskiedenis / Skills of History

X	Die vind van 'n verskeidenheid tipes inligting oor die verlede / <i>Finding a variety of kinds of information about the past.</i>
X	Keuse van relevante inligting / <i>Selecting relevant information.</i>
X	Besluit of inligting vertrou kan word / <i>Deciding about whether information can be trusted.</i>
X	Om iets wat in die verlede gebeur het vanuit meer as een gesigspunt te beskou / <i>Seeing something that happened in the past from more than one point of view.</i>
X	Verduidelik waarom die gebeure uit die verlede dikwels verskillend geïnterpreteer word / <i>Explaining why events in the past are often interpreted differently.</i>
X	Debatteer oor wat gebeur het in die verlede op grond van die beskikbare getuienis / <i>Debating about what happened in the past on the basis of the available evidence.</i>
X	Die skryf van Geskiedenis op 'n georganiseerde wyse, met 'n logiese argumentslyn / <i>Writing history in an organised way, with a logical line of argument.</i>
	Begrip vir die belangrikheid van erfenis en bewaring / <i>Understanding the importance of heritage and conservation.</i>

Konsepte in Geskiedenis / Concepts in History

X	Oorsaak en gevolg / <i>Cause and effect</i>
	Verandering en kontinuïteit / <i>Change and continuity</i>
X	Tyd en chronologie / <i>Time and chronology</i>

Lesdoelwitte / Lesson aims

Aan die einde van die les moet die leerders instaat wees om die volgende te doen / *At the end of the lesson learners should be able to do the following:*

- Identify and list at least two causes of Arab nationalism and two causes of Jewish nationalism (recall).
- Interpret two short historical sources and extract relevant evidence about nationalist aims (interpretation).
- Analyze the reliability and perspective of one source using guided questions (source analysis).
- Construct a short paragraph comparing one cause of Arab nationalism

Les / Lesson

- Inleidingsfase / *Introduction Phase* (____10____Minute / *Minutes*)

Aktiwiteite / <i>Activities</i>	Onderwyser se rol / <i>Teacher's role:</i>	Leerder se rol / <i>Learner's rol:</i>	Assessering / <i>Assessment:</i>	Ondersteuningsmateriaal / <i>Support material</i>
▪ Historical Discussion (5min) ▪ Think-Pair-Share: "What is nationalism?" Learners Write a short definition and one example from previous topics (e.g. Germany or Italy)	▪ Facilitate creation of discussion rules ▪ Establish a respectful and inclusive classroom environment ▪ Clarify the meaning of nationalism ▪ Model historical language and neutrality	▪ Participate respectfully ▪ Share ideas thoughtfully ▪ Record definition ▪ Listen actively to others ▪ Follow discussion guidelines: Respect all viewpoints.	▪ Soort / <i>Type</i> Informal (diagnostic) ▪ Strategie / <i>Strategy</i> Oral questioning and observation checklist ▪ Agent / <i>Agent</i> Teacher ▪ Instrument / <i>Instrument</i> Checklist aligned to aim one.	Whiteboard CAPS Slide with discussion rules

		▪ Use evidence from the sources. ▪ Speak as historians, not from personal or political or religious positions. ▪ Critique ideas not people.		
--	--	---	--	--

Onderrig-en-leer fase / *Teaching and learning phase* (40 Minute / *Minutes*)

Aktiwiteite / <i>Activities</i> Activity 1: ▪ Mini-lecture (10 minutes) ▪ Teacher presents a brief explanation using a timeline on: 1. Ottoman decline 2. Rise of Arab nationalism 3. Rise of Zionism 4. British Mandate	Onderwyser se rol / <i>Teacher's role:</i> 1. Provide concise factual input (10 minutes) 2. Clarify chronology 3. Avoid extended lecturing	Leerder se rol / <i>Learner's rol:</i> 1. Complete timeline 2. Ask clarification questions	Assesering / <i>Assesment:</i> ▪ Soort / <i>Type</i> Informal formative ▪ Strategie / <i>Strategy</i> Check completed timelines ▪ Agent / <i>Agent</i> Teacher ▪ Instrument / <i>Instrument</i>	Ondersteuningsmateriaal / <i>Support material</i> Source pack (1 page) Timeline visual Textbook for background reference
---	---	--	---	--

▪ Learners complete a partially scaffolded timeline worksheet. Activity 2: (15 minutes) ▪ Learners divided into 3 groups: ▪ Group A: Source 1 Arab Nationalism (Extract from Arab Revolt Speech) ▪ Group B: Jewish Nationalism (Extract from Zionist Congress speech) ▪ Group C: British Mandate perspective ▪ Each group answers scaffolded questions: 1. What is the main aim of this source?	Onderwyser se rol / <i>Teacher's role:</i> Circulate and scaffold weaker learners. Support ESL with vocabulary prompts Ensure balanced participation	Leerder se rol / <i>Learner's rol:</i> Analyse the assigned source Extract evidence Teach peers in mixed group	Timeline worksheet Assesering / <i>Assesment:</i> ▪ Soort / <i>Type</i> Formative ▪ Strategie / <i>Strategy</i> Source analysis rubric ▪ Agent / <i>Agent</i> Teacher ▪ Instrument / <i>Instrument</i> Structured worksheet	
--	--	--	---	--

2. Identify two pieces of evidence. 3. Who created this source? 4. Can this source be fully trusted? Why/why not? After 8 minutes groups reform into mixed groups and teach each other. Activity 3: (15 minutes) Evidence based comparison paragraph ▪ learners write a short paragraph: “Compare one cause of Arab nationalism with one cause of Jewish nationalism” Use evidence from the sources. Scaffold provided: • One similarity/ difference sentence	Onderwyser se rol / <i>Teacher's role:</i> Provide writing scaffold Support struggling learners Enforce time limit	Leerder se rol / <i>Learner's role:</i> Write structure paragraph Use direct source evidence	Assesering / <i>Assesment:</i> ▪ Soort / Tpe Formal formative ▪ Strategie / Strategy Paragraph marking with mini rubric ▪ Agent / Agent Teacher ▪ Instrument / Instrument	Ondersteuningsmateriaal / <i>Support material</i> Source Pack (3 short extracts) Comparison paragraph scaffold Rubric
--	--	---	---	---

• Evidence from Source A • Evidence from Source B • Concluding comparative statement Stronger learners: Evaluate which source appears more persuasive and why.			Comparison rubric (aligned to aim 4)	
---	--	--	---	--

Afloopfase / Completion phase (10_Minute / Minutes)

Aktiweite / Activities: ▪ Pair consolidation (5 minutes) Pairs answer: • One cause of Arab nationalism • One caused of Jewish nationalism ▪ One reason they clashed ▪ Exit ticket (individual task):	Onderwyser se rol / Teacher's role: Facilitate recap Collect exit tickets Identify misconceptions	Leerder se rol / Learner's rol: Engage in recap Write a structured response. Submit exit ticket.	Assesering / Assesment: ▪ Soort / Tipe Informal formative ▪ Strategie / Strategy Exit ticket reflection ▪ Agent / Agent Teacher	Ondersteuningsmateriaal / Support material Exit ticket slips
---	---	--	---	--

▪ What evidence today challenged or changed your thinking? ▪ Learners submit their responses before leaving.			▪ Instrument / Instrument Exit slip	
---	--	--	---	--

Tuiswerk (Huiswerk) / Home work:

Write one paragraph answering to what extent were the causes of Arab and Jewish nationalism similar?

Requirements:

Use at least two pieces of evidence from the source pack.

Follow structured paragraph format

Marked using CAPS aligned rubric

Refleksie / Reflection

The structured enquiry approach improved learner engagement compared to lecture only format. Ground rules reduced emotional tension during discussion. The jigsaw method supported multiple perspectives and prevented oversimplification. Time management must remain strict to ensure the comparison paragraph is completed. Future lessons could expand by adding more diverse perspectives beyond the three used.

Source Pack:

Learners will use these sources in activities that are to be done:

Source 1: Arab nationalism

“The Arab nation has long suffered under foreign rule. We demand independence and the right to govern ourselves in the lands where Arabs form the majority. We seek freedom from Ottoman control and recognition of an independent Arab state.”

(Adapted extract from correspondence between Sharif Hussein of Mecca and the British High Commissioner, 1915)

Context Box:

During World War I, Arab leaders negotiated with Britain for independence from the Ottoman Empire. Many Arabs believed Britain promised them independence in return for supporting the war effort.

Source 2: Jewish Nationalism (Zionism)

“The Jewish people are one people. We have maintained our identity despite persecution and exile. We seek to establish a publicly recognised homeland in Palestine where the Jewish people can live safely and freely.”

(Adapted extract from Theodor Herzl’s speech at the first Zionist Congress, 1897)

Context Box:

In the late 19th Century, many Jews in Europe Experienced discrimination and violence. Zionism was a nationalist movement calling for the creation of a Jewish homeland.

Source 3: The British Perspective

“His Majesty’s Government views with favour the establishment in Palestine of a national home for the Jewish people, provided that nothing shall prejudice the civil and religious rights of existing non-Jewish communities in Palestine.”

(Adapted extract from the Balfour Declaration, 1917)

During World War I, Britain issued this declaration supporting a Jewish homeland in Palestine while also promising to protect exiting communities

Learners will complete these activities under educator guidance.

Grade 11 History Worksheet

Topic: Origins of Arab and Jewish Nationalism

Name: _____

Date: _____

Activity 1: Timeline (10 marks)

Complete the timeline by filling in the missing information

Date	Event	Why is it important?
1897		
1915- 1916		
1917		
1920		

Extension Question (no marks)

Explain how these events increased tension in Palestine:

Activity 2: Source Analysis (JIGSAW TASK)

Source A- Arab Nationalism

1. Who created this source? (1)

2. What was the main demand of Arab nationalists? (2)

3. Quote ONE phrase that shows their desire for independence. (2)

4. Why might this source be biased? (2)

Source B- Jewish Nationalism (Zionism)

1. Who Created this source? (1)

2. What was the aim of the Zionist movement? (2)

3. Identify ONE reason why Jews wanted a homeland (2)

4. Why might this source be biased? (2)

Source C- British Perspective (Balfour Declaration)

1. What did Britain promise in 1917? (2)

2. According to the source, whose rights must also be protected? (2)

Why might Britain have made this declaration during World War I? (3)

Activity 3: Comparison Paragraph (10 Marks)

Write one well structured paragraph answering:

Compare ONE cause of Arab nationalism with ONE cause of Jewish nationalism.
Use evidence from the source

Your paragraph must include:

- A comparison sentence (similarity or difference)
- Evidence from source A
- Evidence from Source B
- A concluding statement

EXIT TICKET

What evidence from today's lesson challenged or changed your thinking?

EXIT TICKET

What evidence from today's lesson challenged or changed your thinking?

In the revised lesson, we reduced direct instruction and introduced a timeline overview followed by a guided source analysis activity. In the original lesson, a large portion of the time (35 minutes) was spent on teacher explanation, with students copying notes and participating in an unstructured debate about which nationalism was “more justified.” This encouraged personal opinion rather than historical analysis.

The most significant change we made from the flawed lesson plan to the improved template was moving from a lecture-driven, opinion-based approach to a structured, source-based inquiry approach. Students now work with excerpts from early Arab nationalist and Zionist writings, identify evidence, compare perspectives, and substantiate their responses with references.

Additionally, we included explicit parameters for discussions and a reminder to maintain neutrality and respect by using a “historical lens.”

Teaching the history of Arab and Jewish nationalism carries a significant risk of becoming politically, emotionally, or spiritually controversial. In the absence of framework, students could express personal or biased opinions. By creating ground rules, emphasising evidence-based debate, and employing structured source questions, our revised class lowers this risk. This maintains the academic focus of the lesson and aligns it with the historical inquiry skills of CAPS.

Reference list:

Britannica. *Hussein-McMahon correspondence*. Available at: <https://www.britannica.com/topic/Husayn-McMahon-correspondence> Date of Access: 24 February 2026.

Britannica. 2026. *Balfour Declaration*. Available at: <https://www.britannica.com/event/Balfour-Declaration> Date of Access: 24 February 2026.

Department of Basic Education (DBE). 2011. *Curriculum and Assessment Policy Statement (CAPS): History Grades 10–12*.

Frank F., Stepehenson C., Subramony R., & Sikhakhane L. 2012. *New Generation History Grade 11 Learner Book*. New Generation publishing.

German History in Documents and Images. 2026. *Theodor Herzl, The Jewish State (1896)*. Available at: <https://germanhistorydocs.org/en/wilhelmine-germany-and-the-first-world-war-1890-1918/theodor-herzl-the-jewish-state-1896> Date of Access 24 February 2026.

National Curriculum Statement (NCS). Pretoria: Department of Basic Education.

Marking rubric (Total: 25)

Criterion (Weight)	Inadequate	Developing	Proficient	Excellent
Introduction & Conclusion (8)	Critique: Few/no relevant flaws identified. Improved plan: Little/no activation of prior knowledge; aims unclear; closure missing; no link to sensitive-topic management.	Critique: Some flaws identified but vague or poorly justified. Improved plan: Some activation/closure but weak alignment; limited sensitive-topic strategy.	Critique: Clear flaws identified with workable improvements. Improved plan: Prior knowledge activated; aims mostly clear; closure consolidates learning; some coherent sensitive-topic strategy. Critique:	Critique: Insightful, specific critique with strong, practical improvements. Improved plan: Strong intro and closure; aims measurable and aligned; clear cohesion and consistent sensitive-topic strategy throughout. Critique:
2) Teaching strategy & approach (10)	Critique: Superficial; misses major teaching/learning issues. Improved plan: Activities poorly sequenced; teacher-centred; unsafe discussion approach; limited learner engagement.	Critique: Identifies some issues but limited depth. Improved plan: Some meaningful activities but uneven progression; limited scaffolding; controversial content not handled well.	Identifies key issues and explains impact on learning. Improved plan: Activities mostly meaningful and sequenced; learners engage with sources; appropriate discussion protocols are present. Critique:	Comprehensive and professional, linking flaws to learning. Improved plan: Strong progression from low to high cognition; active learning; evidence-based enquiry; careful and inclusive handling of controversy.
3) Assessment & resources (7)	Critique: Little/no attention to misalignment or resource gaps. Improved plan: Assessment missing/irrelevant; resources vague; no	Critique: Some attention to assessment/resources but incomplete. Improved plan: Basic assessment present but weak alignment; resources listed but	Identifies misalignment and proposes better options. Improved plan: Assessment mostly aligned (formative +	Critique: Precise diagnosis and strong alternatives. Improved plan: Assessment fully aligned and purposeful; clear instructions;

	worksheet/source detail.	not explained.	closure check); resources used appropriately with some detail.	resources integrated with detailed guidance (worksheet/source pack clearly explained).
--	--------------------------	----------------	--	--

TOTAL: 25

Appendix A: AI-generated lesson plan (intentionally flawed) is provided as a separate document for critique.